

Glest



Genre: RTS (real time strategy)

Game play

Glest is a 3D real-time strategy game (or RTS) set in pseudo medieval Europe. The game, as of version 2, features two factions, Tech and Magic. Each faction also has its own unit types, buildings and tech tree (i.e., more stuff to do later). As is typical with RTS games, there are resources to gather and mine.

The interface is quite clutter-free with just the essentials on the screen. At the top of the screen is a bar showing the resources available, like gold, stone and wood; and on the right are your faction management options. It's here that you get to build, upgrade and research new stuff. Rolling over each option tells you what it is and what resources are required.

However, we found a few glitches in the game. The tutorial

was a bit inaccurate. While we were asked to build a certain structure, we found we did not have enough resources and we weren't yet taught how to mine for or gather resources, by that time. Moreover, the game is extremely slow and the lighting is also pretty low, at any time of the day or night. Notification of buildings built or a worker being idle would have been very useful.

Video

Glest's theme is mainly a forest. Each unit has its own animations rendered in 3D. The ogre giant and battle walkers dwarf the other units.

Audio

Sound is probably one of the most underused elements in many open source projects but Glest's effects really boost the game's appeal. The music



is well composed and quite pleasant too. Each unit has its own response when you click on it or send it to do a task. The stone golem and magic armour are particularly good with grave, hollow voices.

Download URL: http://sourceforge.net/projects/glest/files/glest%20source/3.2.2/glest_source_3.2.2.zip/download

Frozen Bubble



Genre: Arcade

Game play

Frozen Bubble is a pop-cap style game that puts the user into a world of coloured balls, ice and penguins. While that might sound a bit silly, that's the whole point. The game works on the same principle as several very popular pop-cap style games such as Dinosaur Eggs and even the classic, Puzzle Bobble that started it all. The concept of Frozen Bubble is simple. The screen is filled with coloured balls that hang down from a gradually descending press plate. Your objective is to aim your igloo cannon at these balls and fire your own coloured balls

at them. If you match three in a row of the same colour, any attached coloured balls of the same colour, or any below them, immediately fall. It's almost like playing Connect Three in reverse. Of course, if the balls that haven't fallen yet touch the igloo, the game's over.

While the game might seem custom made for kids, it will



work as a great stress buster if you manage to sneak the live DVD into your office! Moreover, you can also play against other players on the Internet, and show off your score to the community.

While we could easily get connected to the online server, there were only seven games and three players online. Moreover, what seemed a bit weird was that, other than me, everyone was named FINALFANTA.

Download URL: <http://www.frozen-bubble.org/downloads/>

Words of Caution: EXTREMELY ADDICTIVE!!